Matt List

Lead Engineer · production systems and AI tooling

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SUMMARY

15 years building and running production software, most recently as the lead engineer at AJ Hackett Bungy. I work directly with the people using what I build, scope the problem, write the code, and stay on it through rollout and support. I build agent tooling every day: an MCP platform used by 40% of Bungy staff, a governed automation platform in internal beta, and open-source developer tools people actually download.

SELECTED WORK

Piper — Go · TypeScript · Postgres · MCP · internal beta, 2026

A shared AI workspace where staff build "spaces": live data blocks and scheduled automations that run on the server, not in someone's chat session. Piper connects to MCP servers, OpenAPI services, databases and files, and puts them behind one capability catalogue with per-connection policy, approvals and audit on every call. Claude Code, Codex, Cursor and OpenCode can build spaces through Piper's MCP server. User code runs in a VM with no credentials. The model writes the summaries, but the numbers always come from the data, never from the model.

Scout — TypeScript · MCP · Entra OAuth · production, 2026

Bungy's workplace MCP server. It gives Claude and Codex controlled access to Linear, GitHub, SQL Server, Cosmos DB, Application Insights, Freshdesk, NetSuite, Microsoft Teams and Mailchimp. It uses Entra sign-in and role-based tool access, keeps external systems read-only by default, and audits every write path. Used by 40% of the company so far, and it runs the Zipride and Activities upsell email campaigns and daily performance reporting.

Cellar — Rust · GPUI · open source · 141 stars · 1,200+ downloads

A keyboard-first desktop database client for PostgreSQL, MySQL, SQLite, SQL Server, Firestore, Convex and Cosmos DB. It has a virtualised result grid, reviewable pending row edits, query plans, schema diffing and ER diagrams, and ships as a signed macOS build with 22 releases so far. Built largely with AI coding agents. I review and ship the Rust, but I don't write it by hand.

Sprocket — Swift · open source · Homebrew cask

A macOS menu bar app that watches GitHub Actions across every repo you can see. It uses ETag-aware polling, battery-aware backoff and failure notifications, and keeps your token on your machine.

GooeyPi (contributor) — TypeScript · Electron

Merged features in an open-source desktop workspace for the Pi, OMP and Prime coding agents: project setup and run scripts, queued messages, new-project drafts and a selectable Git worktree checkout strategy.

EXPERIENCE

Solution Architect / Lead Engineer, AJ Hackett Bungy — 2024 – present · Christchurch

- Lead engineering for EpicShot, the platform that captures, edits and sells photos and video of guests. It covers cloud APIs (.NET, Azure), site edge servers, Flutter apps for photographers and guides, GoPro and RFID capture, FFmpeg composition, payments and customer portals. EpicShot content has passed 185 million social media views, and the platform won Excellence in Innovation at the 2025 Queenstown Business Awards.
- EpicShot is live at 8 sites. Each site runs its own edge server so capture and video composition keep working locally, then syncs to the cloud through RabbitMQ and Azure Service Bus.
- Work directly with site operations and guest-facing teams to turn their problems into shipped fixes, often across several systems at once.
- Made GoPro capture reliable enough for daily production: Wi-Fi and BLE setup, upload orchestration, device logging and geofenced capture.

- Run code review and releases for the development team across .NET, Flutter, Svelte, TypeScript and Python. Built Ruru, an AI code reviewer in Go that investigates each pull request, tries to disprove its own findings before posting them, and is measured against a replay set of real pull requests to compare models.
- Built Scout and Piper (above), so upsell campaigns and daily reporting run as scheduled, audited automations instead of manual work.

Software Development Manager, Enviro NZ 2020 – 2024 · Christchurch

- Led a team of up to 5 developers building ERP, integration, mobile, web and reporting software for a national waste and recycling company.
- Rebuilt the weighbridge system in .NET, cutting customer wait times by up to 80% across transfer stations and landfills.
- Designed and built a pay-as-you-throw green waste app and backend for 7,000+ Auckland customers, and an in-cab driver app that replaced paper run sheets.
- Rebuilt the company website in Next.js: 80% faster page loads and 20% more traffic.
- Our council integration work (APIs, React, Flutter, Azure SQL) won the wider technology team an Award for Excellence in the Local Government category.
- Built an internal .NET Core integration API that cut data retrieval times by 60% and ran at 99.8% uptime.
- Led integration design for the move from Dynamics AX 2012 to Dynamics 365 Finance & Operations, and brought in Azure DevOps pipelines and code review.

System Architect, Enviro NZ 2014 – 2020

Dynamics AX development in C# and X++, SSRS reporting, and the EnviroEarth iOS and Android app (Firestore, Stripe, SendGrid).

Technical Business Support, EnviroWaste 2010 – 2015

National support, and small internal apps that automated manual admin work.

SKILLS

AI: MCP servers and clients, agent harnesses (Claude Code, Codex, Amp), tool governance and audit, OpenAI and Anthropic APIs, prompt and model routing

Languages: TypeScript, C#/.NET, Go, Python, Dart/Flutter, Swift, SQL

Platform: Azure (Functions, SQL, Blob, Service Bus, Entra ID), Postgres, SQL Server, Redis, RabbitMQ, Docker, GitHub Actions

OUTSIDE WORK

AI is the hobby as well as the job: I build and test agents, harnesses and models in my own time, and write the occasional essay at matt-nz.com. Otherwise golf, pickleball, and reading science fiction (currently the *Red Rising* series).